

DOCUMENTS

TEXTS ATTRIBUTED TO PETER OF ALEXANDRIA.

THE texts printed or described below are found in the remains of two MSS, to be here designated respectively A and B. To the former of these belonged the fragment ascribed to Peter, which Dr. Carl Schmidt recently published¹. The following table shows those which relate to Peter among the ascertained remnants of the original volume of A, arranged according to their pagination, where that is preserved, or failing that, as internal evidence suggests :—

- a. Paris, MS copte 132¹, fol. 27, (1st of 4th quire, =) *about* p. 50.
- β. „ „ 131¹, fol. 1, pp. 67, 68.
- γ. „ „ 129¹⁴, fol. 131, pp. ?
- δ. Brit. Mus., Or. 3581 A (14), pp. 85, 86.
- ε. Paris, MS copte 130⁶, ff. 123, 124, pp. 89–92.
- ς. „ „ 129¹⁴, fol. 109, pp. ?
- ζ. Zoega, *Catal.*, no. cxxxviii, pp. 135–142.
- η. Paris, MS copte 130⁶, fol. 102, pp. 19, 20.

Of these Aα does not indeed contain positive proof of its ascription to Peter, but its contents make this, in the circumstances, most probable. The position assigned to Aγ is quite hypothetical. Aς is placed next to Aζ merely as being, like it, biographical. Aε, being the leaves edited by Dr. Schmidt and Aβ, Aγ others which he intends to edit², will not be further dealt with here. Aη owes its position to the connexion with the next fragment.

Other work by the scribe of this volume has been preserved : I have seen considerable portions of a History or Miracles of the Virgin (Zoega cxix, cclxiii, cclxxiii) and of Pseudo-Prochorus (Paris 129¹⁷, 72–74, 76–79, *ibid.* 129¹⁸, 109, 110, Zoega cxxxiv), fragments of Gregory

¹ In *Texte und Untersuchungen*, N. F. v 4 (1901). It would be difficult to maintain the genuineness of these texts after Delehaye's criticisms (*Anal. Bolland.* xx 101), though certain of the passages which I here publish may indicate interpolated, rather than wholly apocryphal compositions.

² *V. loc. cit.* 46 as to Aβ (letter to the apostate Apollonius). Dr. Schmidt has also copied Aγ (referring to the imprisoned bishops).

Nazianzen, 'On Baptism and Purity' (Paris 131¹, 58), to which may belong Leyden MS 87 and Paris 132¹, 62 on the same theme; also of the Martyrdom of Psote and Kallinikos (Oxford, Clar. Press, frag. 55, Paris 131⁵, 145), and of the story of Zeno's daughters (Paris 78, 39). The pagination of some of these leaves shows that, with our Petrine texts, they represent different volumes.

The second MS here used, B, is probably also represented by a number of dispersed leaves; but I can attempt no enumeration of them, as I feel uncertain of having as yet distinguished this scribe's hand from others perplexingly like it. We are concerned here with only two fragments, the first of which claims to be by Peter, while the second was, I think, probably ascribed to him:—

Ba. Paris 131⁵, fol. 38, pp. 47, 48.

Bβ. „ „ fol. 59, pp. 67, 68.

The scripts of A and B are very similar in type; features characteristic of each must, as is generally the case, be sought among several of the published facsimiles¹. Both may belong to the eleventh century; yet they might well be still younger. The size of a fol. in A is about 37 × 30.5 cm., that in B about 30 × 24.5 cm. The number of lines to a column in the former is 34—36, in the latter 28—30. It is needless to add that both MSS came from the library of the White Monastery.

Aa.

From an Epistle or Homily, addressed presumably to the community generally. The occasion would appear to be rather during a pause in the persecutions than during their activity. If the text were Peter's, its latter part would be early evidence of a liturgical observance for which hitherto only much later testimony was, I believe, forthcoming.

[fol. a] [πα]ντρε αμεριτ απρρσκληρος αππειαποττε απποτε
 πσεριοτε επετπστπγραφос жеетπн петппатрωп псепараγζот
 ммон епетсгх псеѡѡю απεπωпг епеснт епеттако ммин
 ммоот · απρшωпe πατπωмон еѡλ жепшанфантасисѡаг рппе-
 платиа мпπολс сепшаже псωп пѡг пепжжете етжω ммос
 жепоѡе етжосеже рнт пѣре псепнт ап еотωшт ппποтте απρро ·
 атω птегге отпотпѡс патαγiα απотштортп пашωпe мппстос
 παг етмооше псатоѡе (*sic*) ппехристiанос мпатрiархис · †соотп
 гар песпнт атω †поег жемппетпапотч рптеимптеро таг · пλнп
 м[п]ршωп[ε] пѡроп [п]пгеλλ[нп] жеппeотмшe шωпe оттωп

¹ E. g. Ciasca, tabb. xi, xiii, xviii, xxii.

нмнат · марепнеж пенроотш епнотте атω егнашωпе нан
 мпростатис атω парχη атω пжωк · аноп де ω песпнт мареп-
 спотдазе епарахωрей пат епсоотн жесεεπλοιθε ерон пнат нм
 рартмперро мпараломос · мпеотоеиш ереїт пенжоеис периеїѡ
 мпнотте пшнре псаѡаωѡ ꝑсѡа ппечапостоѡос шяѡжоос жеотой
 ппетерепескапдаалон ннт еѡл ритоотот · мпертрескапдаалон
 шωпе еѡл ритоотн ω песпнт ммерит епсоотн пантωс жепкосмос
 отлаатпе атω [fol. b] [ѡ]папар[аѡ]ε-пѡе пот[ра]сот · еис ринте
 [ω] песпнт [а]ппаакε мпештортр рон еротн енетптопос · арире
 ппетпсгназис χωрис мптреѡжнат · мпркласматизе псон спат
 рижпотѡтсгастиріон потωт потроот потωт еѡл жеаттамон
 жеатмтстирион мпотѡлп еѡл шωпе рижмпеѡтсгастиріон пай
 ꝑнатсаѡωтн ероѡ · асшωпе де псотмнпн мпехот птаѡотеіпе
 ереотмнише пепископос сωотр еткаѡоликн стгназис рмптопос
 етеіре прме мпшомнт енепископос · лопон птерепмнише
 сωотр етекклнсія етепсгнаге прнтс · рмптресмот ппептап-
 класматизе ммоот сωр ехмппмнише атехриа шωпе етрепелне
 препкеоеік рїѡл птпсѡратизе ммоот рмппотиріон птпклас-
 матизе ммоот · рмптреритоотн де мпперме пепископос
 екласматизе мпсωма мпепжоеис їѡ пеѡѡт · еис отсми асшωпе
 шарон есжω ммос жеѡрни пнтн ω пшоос етмооне мпооре
 песоот плогикон мпеѡѡт · пай де птерепсωтм ероот апωнш ·
 апнат рωс отсрїме есагератс птпе ммон ереотшнре шнм
 епесωѡ рижмпесѡѡи еѡсоотн ерон мпечтннѡе спат еѡжω ммос
 жеѡрни пнтн тиртн ω пшоос етѡтааѡ етмооне калωс · алла
 мпреіре мпеіρωѡ ппоѡе птеімне жиппеінат ммон¹ ететн (*sic*
expl.)

[fol. a] Beloved sons, be not severe (σκληρός) with these godless
 ones, lest (μήποτε) they beat your . . . (σύγγραφος *pl.*), saying: 'Where
 are your patrons² (πάτρων *pl.*)?' and we be delivered (παραδίδοναι) into
 their hands and they humble our life down to (the level of) their own
 depravity (*lit.* destruction). Be not reckless (ἀγνώμων); because if we
 appear (φαντάζεσθαι) in the streets of the cities (πλατεία, πόλις), our
 enemies will talk against us, saying: 'Whence (πόθεν *sic*) are they thus

¹ For *αμμον* here cf. my *Ostraca*, no. 83, and the quotations there.

² I leave the explanation of these words to those familiar with the early
 organization of the Christian community in Egypt. One might regard the former
 word as = συγγραφεὺς, here some responsible scribe or notary. 'Patron' might be
 the patron of a *collegium*, or perhaps here = *advocatus*.

so proud and come not to worship the king's gods?' And thus a great disorder (*ἀταξία*) and disturbance shall befall the faithful (*πιστός*) who walk in the fear (?)¹ of the Christian patriarchs (*πατριάρχης*). For (*γάρ*) I know, brethren, and am aware (*νοεῖν*) that there is nothing good in this kingdom. Nevertheless (*πλήν*) be not stumbling-blocks unto the heathen (*Ἑλλην*)², lest a conflict arise between us and them. Let us cast our care upon God and He will be for us a helper (*προστάτης*) and a beginning (*ἀρχή*) and an end³. But (*δέ*) as for us, O brethren, let us be diligent (*σπουδαῖν*) to give place (*παραχωρεῖν*) unto them, knowing that they do take occasion against us at all times before their unrighteous (*παράνομος*) king. In the time when Jesus our Lord, the Lamb of God, the Son of Sabaoth, did teach His apostles (*ἀπ.*), He used to say: 'Woe unto them by whom offences (*σκάνδαλον*) come'⁴. Let not offences (*σκ.*) arise through us, O beloved brethren, who fully (*πάντως*) know that the world (*κόσμος*) is nought and [fol. *δ*] that it shall pass (*παράγειν*) as a dream⁵. Behold, brethren, the pains of the disturbance are come nigh your τόποι. Hold your congregations (*σύναξις*) without (*χωρίς*) neglectfulness⁶. Break (*κλασματίζειν*) not (bread) twice upon the same altar (*θυσιαστήριον*) on the same day⁷; for we have been told that a mystery (*μυστήριον*) and a revelation happened at the altar (*θυσ.*); and this I will relate to you⁸. It happened (+ *δέ*), on the fifteenth day of the past month, when a number of bishops (*ἐπ.*) were gathered for the general communion (*καθολικὴ σύναξις*)⁹ in the τόπος, making forty and three bishops (*ἐπ.*); then (*λοιπόν*), after that the multitude was gathered at the church (*ἐκκ.*) wherein we should meet together (*συνάγειν*), while the blessing¹⁰ of the (breads) which we had broken (*κλασμ.*) was spreading among the multitude, it became needful (*χρεία*) that we should bring forth other breads and sign (*σφραγίζειν*) them in the cup¹¹ (*ποτήριον*) and

¹ Text perhaps corrupt.

² Cf. 1 Cor. i 23.

³ Cf. 1 Pet. v 7; Apoc. i 8.

⁴ Cf. Matt. xviii 7.

⁵ 'Dream' not quite certain. Cf. 1 John ii 17.

⁶ The word translates *ἀκηρὸς*, Eccli. xxii 1.

⁷ This rule is found in a canon, attributed in the end of the twelfth century to Gregory Nyss. (v. Riedel, *KRQuellen* 102, also *ibid.* 61). Vansleb mentions the custom (*Histoire* 94). In the West it was apparently accepted by a sixth-century synod at Auxerre (Martène, *ed. nov.*, lib. i, c. 3, art. iii, § xxii; but cf. M.'s interpretation, art. vi, § xii).

⁸ Or 'at this altar. I will relate it to you.'

⁹ I find this expression in the Sa'idic version of Eustathius' *Encomium on St. Michael* (Berlin, MSor. 1611, fol. 1), where Boh. has simply *σύναξις* (Budge, p. 125, 24); also in the Life of Pesynthius (*Inst. égypt.*, Mém. ii 393), bishops being in both cases celebrants.

¹⁰ The word corresponds to *εὐλογία*, e. g. *Mission franç.* iv 721. Cf. my *Ostraca*, no. 90, and Lagarde, *Aeg.* 259 *supra* = Tattam, p. 66.

¹¹ Cf. Renaudot, *Lit. Or. Coll.* (ed. 1847), 240, 320.

should break (κλασμ.) them. But (δέ) whilst we, with the forty bishops (ἐπ.), were about to break (κλασμ.) the body (σῶμα) of our Lord Jesus Christ, lo, a voice came to us, saying: 'Peace (εἰρήνη) unto you, O shepherds that pasture Christ's reasonable (λογικός) flock of sheep.' But (δέ) when we had heard these (words), we were amazed and we beheld as it were (ὥς) a woman, standing over us, a fair boy being upon her arm, who stretched toward us his two fingers¹, saying: 'Peace (εἰρήνη) unto you all, O holy shepherds which pasture aright (καλῶς). But (ἀλλά) do not this sinful deed from henceforth. For ye (*sic exph.*).

Αδ.

From an Epistle, which the anecdote of Theonas shows to be Peter's. It is addressed to the orthodox community, clearly in the midst of a persecution, and exhorts them to avoid contact with heretics². We have in it a curious instance of superstition, related to the belief in the Evil Eye and similar influences³.

[fol. a] шареппоће фотω птетепростасис аτζапе · мпрѣтwn
 пмаат епτηрѣ хпгтооте шаротре хепзωγμος пашт емае ·
 мпποτε псепаразгзот мμωтп етоотот ппетархей псерωм ежωтп
 птетпттωотп · шлнл шптетпней ебол гмппирасмос пѳе етснр
 хепеп̄па меп роотт тсарз де отасѳепнсте · мпрре ебол
 гмперзмот мппште псеппаг ерωтп етпос̄ ппоће гптмппхоеис ·
 птетпκλнропомей мпсарот епма мпесмот · отпе прωћ епот-
 пстос еѣшахе мпотапстос · аште тстмфωпнсис мпех̄т мпѳе-
 лгар · аште тмерис епотекκλнсга пте прерагтпкос мптстмфωпга
 мме мпех̄т мптеѣекκλнсга · мпршлнл гптекκλнсга прггρε-
 тпкос · отте мпрхпегз птоотот алла пωт птп псабол ппетек-
 κλнсга апхоеис гар каат псωѣ еѣшω ммос хееис петпнп кн
 ерωтп еѣмотте епетекκλнсга хепетнп · апок гарпе пхоеис
 мпанп аппе хепсеεгге ап мпетсортωп пргтот · паг гар аапа (*sic*)
 ѳεωпа пептаѣсапотшт пептаѣшп птагаторхп ммаркос апок
 гжωт аттапгорт ерос мпечжωккп епег гпотмоот хпптаѣрепс-
 копос отаттωлм гарп[е] атω аѣжωккп пшомпт п[соп] епотгроот
 по[тωт] · етћеот аѣ[жωккп] [fol. б] фпатамωтп етаттга птаѣжωккп
 етћннтс · епгзп пѣѣмгрте птлезгс етснр хееккжωккп мпексωма
 гпотмоот пктћћок ершпѳадћес мпасећнс тарок · апжωпѣ

¹ Is this any indication of the date of our text?

² Part of this text will be printed in my forthcoming Catalogue as no. 186.

³ The only reference I have found in Christian texts to the fear of shadows is in the 'liturgy,' Vassiliev, *Anecd. Gr. Byz.* 336, and there the δαιμονιακὸν σκίον may simply mean 'terror.'

ψωπε ποτρωοτ εψπαπρονλθε ρηταγορα πσι παειωτ θεωπα · αχει
 ρωωψ πσι οτκαταδικος ηραιρετικος εψπαραγε ετεπισκοποσπε πτε
 θαρρεσις ηπισμοπιανος παλ ετο μπλανος ρητετφτςις ατεψραηες
 ταρεπαειωτ θεωπα πτεψομ απτε πτετποτ ακοτψ επαροτ απεψ-
 ακωκ επρωη ετεψηηκ ετληνιτψ · αψχοος [ε]τρετεινε παψ [π?]ποτ-
 λακαπη μ[μο]οτ ατω αψσερ[πψ] ησαοτσα ρμ[πεπ]σκοπιον αψ . . . ?
 · ατω μπησαοτκοτι αψαγτει μπμοοτ μπμερσεπςπατ · ατω ψαπ-
 μερψομπτ ησοη αψχωκμ εψχω μπειψαλμωο · ηεκπαθεψψωψτ
 ρποτρεσσωπος εβολ ρμπεςποψ μπψε τατηηο κπαχοκμετ εβολ
 ηρητψ ηπαοτθαψ ηροτο ετχιωπ · πτερειμεμε δε εροψ ηεαψρπαρ
 περεθοο οτ μοποη ψαοτσοη αλλα ψαψομπτ ησοη απρηπηρε
 εματε αποτωψ δε εηποτψ ετηπειρωη · πεχαψ παη ηεετθεοτ
 τετμμεετε εβολ ρμπετηρητ ετηεπενταλααψ μποοτ παρ παεθοο ·
 ηποττε γαρπε παμπτρε ηεηηπαηηοτε απ ετοτρωορ εαψκποοο ηεε
 μπειραρετικος · εμμοοψε γαρ μποοτ ειοτωψ εβωκ ψαπαρχωπ
 ετηρερηνηκε εατ (*sic expl.*)

[p. 85] . . . iniquity flourisheth and outward pomp (*πρόστασις*) in-
 creaseth (*αυξάνειν*). Contend not with them at all, from morning until
 evening, for the persecution (*διωγμός*) is very heavy; lest (*μήποτε*) they
 deliver (*παράδιδόναι*) you into the hands of them that rule (*ἄρχειν*) and
 they trample upon you and ye rise not again. Pray till ye come forth
 from temptation (*πειρασμός*), as it is written: 'The spirit indeed (*πνεῦμα*
μέν) is willing, but the flesh (*σὰρξ δέ*) is weak (*ἀσθενής*)¹. Fall not away
 from the grace of God, lest (*λίτ.* that) this be reckoned unto you by the
 Lord for a great sin and that ye inherit (*κληρονομεῖν*) the curse in place
 of the blessing². What is the business of a believer (*πιστός*) talking
 with an unbeliever (*ἄπιστος*); what is the agreement (*συμφώνησις*) of
 Christ with Beliar³? What is the part (*μέρις* *sic*) of a church (*ἐκκ.*) of
 the heretics (*αἱρετικός*) with the true concord (*συμφωνία*) of Christ with
 His church (*ἐκκ.*)? Pray not in the heretics' church (*ἐκκ. αἱρ.*) neither
 (*οὔτε*) receive oil at their hands⁴, but (*ἀλλά*) flee ye from their churches
 (*ἐκκ. ρλ.*); for (*γάρ*) the Lord hath abandoned them, saying: 'Lo, your
 house is left unto you⁵, He calling their churches (*ἐκκ. ρλ.*) their houses.
 For (*γάρ*) I am not lord of mine house, for they do not that which is
 right therein (MS in them)⁶. For (*γάρ*) Apa Theôna⁷, he that did

¹ Matt. xxvi 41.

² Cf. 1 Pet. iii 9.

³ Cf. 2 Cor. vi 15, and the version in Lagarde, *Aeg.* 224, 285.

⁴ Of the various liturgical uses of oil, presumably the anointing of the sick, &c. is here intended.

⁵ Matt. xxiii 38.

⁶ A reference to the Meletians?

⁷ Presumably a verb has fallen out: 'This [did] Apa Th. . . . he never'.

nourish me (and) that received the succession (διαδοχή) of Mark—I too have been entrusted therewith¹—did never wash in water since he became bishop (ἐπίσκοπος); for (γάρ) he was spotless; yet (λίτ. and) did he wash thrice in a single day. Wherefor did he wash? [p. 86] I will recount to you the cause (αἰτία) for which he washed. Now (ἐπειδή) he used to hold-fast by the verse (λέξις) which is written², saying: ‘Thou shalt wash thy body (σῶμα) in water and shalt be purified, if the shadow of the wicked (ἀσεβής) touch thee.’ The chance befell on a day, as my father Theôna would go (προελθεῖν) to the market-place (ἀγορά), there came also a damnable (κατάδικος) heretic (αἵρετικός), passing by (παράγειν), being a bishop (ἐπ.) of the heresy (αἵρεσις) of the Simonians³ (σιμωνιανός), those who are in error (πλάνος) in their nature (φύσις). His shadow touched my father Theôna, (but) not his power. Forthwith he turned back and went not to the matter concerning which he had come. (And) he bade a dish (λακάνη) of water to be brought him and he bathed himself at one side of the bishop’s-house (ἐπισκοπέιον) (and) he . . . And after a little, he asked for (αἰτεῖν) water a second time and until three times and washed, saying this Psalm⁴: ‘Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop from the blood of the wood and I shall be clean. Thou shalt wash me therewith and I shall be white beyond the snow (χιών).’ But (δέ) when we knew him to have done against (παρά) his custom (ἔθος), not only (οὐ μόνον) once but (ἀλλά) up to three times, we were greatly amazed and (δέ) we desired to ask him concerning this matter. He said unto us: ‘Wherefor do ye consider in your hearts concerning that I have done to-day, against (παρά) my custom (ἔθος)? For (γάρ) God is my witness that I will not be defiled by a stinking dog like this heretic (αἵρ.). For (γάρ) I was walking to-day, intending to go to the magistrate (ἄρχων) concerning some poor who had (sic *expl.*).

Cf. *Passio*, ed. Viteau, 75 ὁ ἀναθρέψας με πατήρ μου καὶ ἐπίσκ. Θ., and *ibid.* 79; also Migne, *PL.* 18, 460 (? Anastasius) ‘pater meus qui me nutritiv sanctissimus Th. ep., cujus pontificalem cathedram regere suscepit.’ So too the Bohairic, ed. Hyvernat, 274.

² Whence comes this quotation?

³ These Gnostics are included in Maruta’s list, ca. 400, though possibly only as a reminiscence (*v.* Harnack, *TU.*, N. F. iv 1, pp. 7, 13). As such they appear in Abū ’l Barakāt in the fourteenth century (Riedel, *KRQuellen* 17). To assume that Nestorians are here intended (*v.* Gibbon, ed. Bury, v 119) would credit our text with a too glaring anachronism.

⁴ Ps. 19 (Greek), according to the Sa’idic version. But an interesting though late (ca. twelfth cent.) Greek-Sa’id. liturgical MS (Brit. Mus., Or. 5465) gives a number of Psalm verses, among them this, in a form showing whence the current Sa’idic was translated: ραντοῖς (= ραντιεῖς) με οσοπον (= ὕσσῳπῳ) ἀπο τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ξύλου (= ξύλου) καθαρῖσθαισιν με (= -θήσομαι) πλενῖς (= πλυνεῖς) μου (= με) ἐξ αὐτοῦ ἀπερ (= ὑπὲρ) χιόνα λευκανθσονμαι (= -θήσομαι). Comparison of this MS with the corresponding passages of Cod. U (Br. Mus. Pap. xxxvii) shows, as might indeed be expected, identity with its readings. Cf. Brightman in this *JOURNAL*, ii 275.

A5.

The earlier of the two biographical fragments narrates an encounter between Peter, when but a deacon, and Diogenes, a heathen philosopher. Each had desired an acquaintance with the other. When they meet, Diogenes exhibits his magical powers. Peter, to vindicate the superiority of Christianity, asks leave of the then aged archbishop [Theonas] to undertake the cure of the philosopher's only daughter, who suffers from a disease of the eyes (ερερενλετκωα ει εβολ ρηπεχαλ). He is forthwith ordained presbyter and, at a second meeting, before the assembled multitude, while Diogenes expounds the doctrines of Pythagoras and Plato, Peter cites passages (χρησις ρλ.) from the scriptures. The girl, aged 13, is then introduced (*sic expl.*).

I leave this passage and Aζ, which treats of the martyrdom of the saint, to the investigations of Prof. Achelis, who has promised a monograph upon Peter.

Aη.

I could not connect this dilapidated fragment with the name of Peter, until, when already going to press, I chanced upon Kabis's quotation¹ of a corresponding passage from Cod. Vatic. lxi (dated 962). Mai's description of this volume² showed it to contain in fact a homily by Peter and made it probable that our next fragment, Ba, belonged to the same work; and this was, by Prof. Guidi's ever ready help, proved to be the case.

The first phrases are addressed to a single individual: [p. 19] '... teach thee for reward. God forbid³. But I would thou shouldst find freedom (παρρησία) in the day wherein is no respect of persons, and that I also may say before Christ, the true shepherd: "Lo, I and the children whom God hath given me⁴. Lo, ... thou hast entrusted (?) ..."' After a long *lacuna*: επτε ρη[ααα η]ψα μπλ [ετ]μοτε επ[ου κεαλ]λων δε πε ρεπ ηςψποττε [η]οτωα λαατ αν [ρο]λως ηςατο[ι . . . μπρερηρε [η]ηςψποττε ε[θε]παη περεπεψω[αα] ψεψψποττε εβολ ηπατ [ηα] ηζωον δε η[τιμην]ε ψαρε [ε]ι εβολ [[p. 20] μπ . . . η ετχοσε . τ ηπεψ ε ετψαν- [οτωψ δε] εορηψ [ψατχι] ποτψπητε . . . οτςψποττε ψ ηρη[τ] ατω ψατ ηςερηη ψ ηεζο

¹ *Aeg. Zeitschr.*, 1875, 84 *infra*.

² *Scr. Vet. Nov. Coll.* v 156. But Zoega prints (p. 62) the title of the καθήγησις, showing that 'qui suffectus est S. Athanasio' (i. e. Peter II) is gratuitously inserted by Mai.

³ The word translates *μὴ γένοιτο*.

⁴ Heb. ii 13.

εαυτωπε¹ μ[παλ]λων οταμο[ποη α]ε περτωμα . . . τααυ πετο
 π π αλλα ω εττ [long lacuna] εβολ προητη
 χειρομινт πши ραοτши εβολ προητη ενειποσ² απ ειτω ππαι εροκ
 ω πρωμε αλλα ειотωш ετρεπεκσ†ποτше μοошше εποτε ετћεпек-
 празис етпапотот птакаат ρμπε[κ]ωпρ.

A translation here is scarcely possible. It will be seen that the passage treats of the fabulous 'Aloe³,' an account of which appears to have been incorporated in that recension of the *Physiologus* whence the Copts derived their version. Our fragments are in phraseology closely akin to the Middle-Egyptian text edited by Erman⁴: the creature is found in the East and named αλλωη; it lives solely upon 'perfume and the flowers of the perfume (plant),' so that its body continually gives out sweet odours; it is caught in a net; three (*sic*) measures (of gold? are given) for one of its (perfume). 'I do not . . . when I tell thee these things, O man; but I would that thy perfume should travel far because of thy good deeds that thou in thy life hast done.'

Ba.

From another copy of the same work as the foregoing. The reference to Peter's predecessor, Theonas, is intended as evidence of authorship. The interest of the fragment lies in the citation of two heretical writers. Both names are presumably distorted. In the Boh. version, however, whence Prof. Guidi has kindly copied this passage, the first is 'the heretic' Isidōros, while the second, originally Isiôdês, has likewise been altered to Isidore. This should be a reminiscence of Basilides' son⁵.

[p. 17] ατω αϣ†τοотϣ αϣτοτпосϣ πεχαϣ χειπρρρροτε πρωμε
 πшоташϣ ραпηλ птапхоεис тппоотт шарок етalloк еρωη пμ
 етκшпне пcowт · апокпe мшханл пархнстратитос птбom
 мпхоεис атетпeмe χειппето ппoб емшханл ρппaттeлoc ·
 ешхeпархнстратитоспe oткoтп птoчпe пeтпoб тпpoт хeппeп-
 тоhтћ мпшхe пoе етepepoпe ωп пттeпecic птаeпωтнc cмптc
 е†отћe ттeпecic мμωтcнc хeптaтпeж пaгaбoлoc εβολ ρппe
 етћeтkaкia птаϣхпoc пaϣ мμп мμoϣ εaтkaθicтa мμшханл

¹ My copy has εωεп. Perhaps = εωρσ?

² Obscure. Perhaps 'I do not lie,' though I cannot read my copy so.

³ A confusion between plant and supposed animal may be assumed here, similar to that between palm-tree and phoenix (*v. Spiegelberg in Festschr. z. 46. Philologen-versamm.*, 1901). It is to be noted that in the Boh., as in our text, the description is of a beast, not a bird, like the Mid.-Egyptian.

⁴ *Aeg. Zeitschr.* xxxiii 54.

⁵ On Isidore *v. Krüger in PRE³*, ii 432. No work comparable in title to that here cited is attributed to him.

επεμα θεετπαστηριστα αμοу ριον απекритис αμε ετρεφπρεс-
 ђете ρапσωпт тнрѣ θεοταγαθοσπε · οτпe πшаже πтасинтис сраѣ
 ρμπερλѣе жептерепхоеис тαμο πααα αϋχοос псапа-[р. αη]
 -танл жеамот ρωωκ πτοτωшт απρωѣ ппавѣ αϋχοос жепѣпа-
 отωшт ап жепппето ппоѣ еροι псаѣλλακ εϋτω αμοс жеειοτωшт
 ρω εтрашпe πρисос αππαατωотртос ειεппе αμοу · птерεϋѣппе
 птeικακia πρηтѣ пѣи ппotte αϋтреота ппeιxεротѣп сокѣ εѣол
 птапте ппωпe пκωрт αϋпохѣ ερра εхппкаρ απρεпкеμнше
 παττελος пмаαϋ пaι птаϋρραλ αμοот · птетпот αϋотерсарпe
 пѣи ппotte екωлт αппа пѣωκ εрра потпос ποτοεиш отe
 пкеαττελος пte ппotte εтаτρεтѣωκ епеснт εхппкаρ · ѣпат
 епакроатис ετοτωшт εхпоти жеппреϋσκοптеι отe λομωс парша
 ρμпша απархаττελος мханл ѣпaжω ерωтп απентаαειωт
 птаϋсапотшт апа ѣεωпа тaтoу еροι εѣол жеαгхпотѣ ρω (*sic expl.*).

‘and he gave his hand and raised him up, saying, “Fear not, Daniel, thou man greatly beloved. The Lord hath sent me to thee to tell thee all things about which thou shalt ask. I am Michael, the captain (*ἀρχιστρατηγός*) of the host of the Lord¹.” Ye know that there is none greater than M. among the angels; if he is the captain, is it not then (*οὐκοῦν*) he who is the greatest of them all? But let us not bandy (= *σοφίζειν* in 2 Pet. i 16) words, in the manner of some who take account of the *Genesis* (*γένεσις*) which Enôtês composed, to set against the *Genesis* of Moses, when it says² that the Devil (*διάβολος*) was cast out of heaven because of the evil (*κακία*) which he had brought forth and that Michael was set (*καθιστάναι*) in his place, that he might be associated with (*συνιστάναι*) the just judge (*κριτής*), and might be the ambassador (*πρεσβεύειν*) for all creation; for he is good (*ἀγαθός*). What are the words which Siêtês in his madness wrote? That³ after the

¹ Cf. Daniel x 11 ff.

² I have found no traces of the legend of Satan’s displacement by Michael beyond the allusion in *Assump. of Moses*, ed. Charles, p. 39, and in the ‘Prayer of the Virgin,’ ed. Basset, *Apocr. éthiop.* v, and *Proc. Soc. Bibl. Arch.* xix 217.

³ This legend is met with in Byzantine and Syrian literature, and was incorporated in the Koran (*v.* Bonwetsch’s ‘Questions of Bartholomew,’ *Götting. Nachr.*, 1897, 36 ff.). Apparent traces of it in earlier times are noted by W. Meyer in the Munich *Abhandlungen* xiv 3, 198. A rabbinic version is given by M. Grünbaum, *Neue Beiträge* 70. It is related as follows in another Coptic encomium on Michael, attributed to Chrysostom (Paris 131¹, 43): ‘The angels beheld the likeness and image of God in Adam and they fell down and worshipped him and gave him glory as the likeness of God. But Mastêma, which is Sataniêl, saw the honour that was given to Adam and he was greatly jealous. He stiffened his neck before the Lord and said unto the angels: “It befits not us to worship Adam, for he is virgin (*παρθενικός*) earth; but we are

Lord had created Adam, He said unto Sanatiël, "Come thou too and worship the work of my hands." And he said, "I will not worship; for there is none greater than I excepting thee," saying (besides?), "I too desire to be equal to (ἴσος) the (MS my) demiurge (δημιουργός) and like him." When God had found in him this wickedness (κακία), He caused one of the Cherubim to drag him from (?) the midst of the fiery stones¹ (and) He cast him down upon the earth and with him a multitude of angels besides whom he had deceived. Forthwith God commanded to close (κωλύειν) the place of ascent for a long time, between (them and) the other angels of God, that they should not be able to descend upon the earth. I see the listeners (ἀκροατής) wishing to ask me, saying, "Shall no scoffer (σκώπτειν) nor scoundrel (λοιμός) keep festival at the feast of the archangel Michael?" I will relate to you what my father Theōna, that nourished me, told me; for I too asked him' (*sic expl.*).

Bβ.

An abstract of this text will suffice to show that it recounts an incident of the same type as that in Dr. Schmidt's published fragment. The passages in inverted commas are translations.

[p. 67] 'Let us honour the martyrs, that they may pray for us and that we may obtain heaven.' What follows regards ceasing from evil-doing and insists that repentance is ever open to all. There was a presbyter named John who, with a deacon Athanasius and a reader Apollo, did² the service (συνάγειν) in the τόπος of St. Mary. The presbyter was rich and had lost his wife; her domestic work (παιρῶν πύριον) was done for him by a woman who came in and out of his house. 'But the devil filled his heart toward her and he sought a time of this sort (i.e. an opportunity for evil).' It happened one day that they were drinking wine together at midday and they carried out the iniquity (παρανομία) together (*sic expl.*).

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angels (formed) of flames of fire and honourable, (made) from the elements (ἕλη πλ.) of fire, while he is earth from the earth." And he desired in his wickedness to lead astray (σκανδαλίζειν) the angels, going in and stiffening his neck before God. But Michael the archangel and all the orders (τάγμα πλ.) of heaven marvelled at the pride of the devil (διάβολος) and his vainglory (κενοδοξία) and they hardened their hearts against his tyranny (τύραννος), beseeching him daily that he would leave his pride and repent and become humble and remain in his honour. But he would not hear them, but he conceived trouble, &c.' (Ps. vii 15-17). On the name Mastēma v. Rönsch, *B. der Jubileen* 107. Other occurrences in Coptic texts: *Proc. Soc. Bibl. Arch.*, l.c.; *Mission franç.* iv 776; cf. Pereira, *Abba Samuel* 146. The legend of Sataniel had reached Severus of Ashmunain (v. Renaudot, *Litt. Or. Coll.*, ed. 1847, i 278).

¹ Cf. Ezek. xxviii 16 (LXX) and perhaps *Secrets of Enoch*, ed. Morfill and Charles, 35.

² *Lit.* 'was doing.' The meaning presumably is 'was in the habit of doing.'